Goodwill Ohio Valley | Employee Experience

Professional Development Plan

Name: Michael Mersman

Date: 04/12/2026

Position: Assistant Manager

Work Location: 9033 Deerfield

My ultimate goal: Advance from Assistant Manager to Store Manager by developing comprehensive retail operations knowledge, strengthening leadership capabilities, and expanding operational expertise beyond hardlines and donation door functions.

Goal 1	Goal 2	Goal 3
Complete comprehensive softlines merchandising and administrative systems training to achieve proficiency in all store operational areas within six months, as measured by successful completion of production workshops and demonstration of competency in pricing, merchandising, and inventory management for softlines departments.	Develop advanced leadership and team management skills by shadowing three high-performing managers at higher volume stores for a minimum of 40 hours total, focusing on staff development, conflict resolution, and performance management techniques.	Establish a structured career advancement timeline by creating a detailed 18-month professional development roadmap that identifies specific competency milestones, required certifications, and performance benchmarks necessary for store manager promotion consideration.
Type of Goal ☐ Personal/Interpersonal Growth ☐ Technical/Job Skills ☐ Leadership Capabilities ☐ Career Planning	**Type of Goal** ☐ Personal/Interpersonal Growth ☐ Technical/Job Skills ○ Leadership Capabilities ☐ Career Planning	**Type of Goal** ☐ Personal/Interpersonal Growth ☐ Technical/Job Skills ☐ Leadership Capabilities ☐ Career Planning
My Why Michael's current expertise in hardlines and donation door operations represents only a portion of the knowledge required for effective store management. Mastering softlines merchandising and administrative systems will eliminate operational blind spots that could compromise his ability to lead effectively and support team members across all departments. This comprehensive understanding directly supports Goodwill's mission by ensuring consistent quality and service delivery that maximizes revenue to fund mission programs.	**My Why** Transitioning from individual contributor to store leader requires mastery of interpersonal dynamics and team motivation strategies that extend beyond operational knowledge. Observing successful leaders in high-pressure environments will provide Michael with practical tools for inspiring excellence and managing diverse team personalities. Strong leadership capabilities ensure team members feel valued and supported, which directly impacts customer service quality and mission fulfillment.	**My Why** Michael's progression from donation door attendant to assistant manager demonstrates his commitment to growth, but advancing to store manager requires strategic planning rather than organic development. A structured roadmap will provide clear expectations and accountability measures while ensuring he develops the comprehensive skill set necessary for successful store leadership. This intentional approach maximizes his potential to contribute meaningfully to OVGI's mission through effective store management.
Timeframe ☐ 1 month ☐ 3 months ☐ 6 months ☐ 1 year	**Time Frame** ☐ 1 month ☐ 3 months ☐ 6 months ☐ 1 year	**Timeframe** ○ 1 month ☐ 3 months ☐ 6 months ☐ 1 year

Personal/Interpersonal Growth (EI, self-awareness, communication, relationships); Technical/Job Skills (role-specific capabilities, processes, systems); Leadership Capabilities (leading others, managing, influencing); Career Planning (advancement, new roles, long-term trajectory).

Consider setting goals in different areas.

Goodwill Ohio Valley | Employee Experience

Professional Development Plan

Action	Goal(s)	Support Partner*	Resources**	Dates	Achieved
Attend all available production workshops focusing on softlines processing, pricing strategies, and merchandising standards over the next four months.	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	L&D Department	EAP HR L&D OC Wellness Other	Begin by: Complete by:	○ Yes ○ No
Complete weekly shadowing sessions with administrative staff to learn inventory management systems, reporting procedures, and compliance requirements.	☑ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3	Store Manager at 9033 Deerfield	EAP HR L&D OC Wellness Other	Begin by: Complete by:	○ Yes ○ No
Schedule and complete shadowing experiences with managers at three different high-volume stores, focusing on peak operational periods and challenging situations.	☐ 1 ☑ 2 ☐ 3	Regional Manager	EAP HR L&D OC Wellness Other	Begin by: Complete by:	○ Yes ○ No
Participate in monthly leadership discussion groups or peer mentoring sessions to practice management scenarios and receive feedback on leadership approach.	☐ 1 ☑ 2 ☐ 3	L&D Department	EAP HR L&D OC Wellness Other	Begin by: Complete by:	○ Yes ○ No
Collaborate with current manager and HR to develop comprehensive competency assessment and create detailed 18-month advancement timeline with specific milestones.	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☑ 3	HR Business Partner	EAP HR L&D OC Wellness Other	Begin by: Complete by:	○ Yes ○ No
Establish quarterly progress review meetings with supervisor to evaluate advancement readiness and adjust development plan based on performance and organizational needs.	☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☑ 3	Store Manager at 9033 Deerfield	EAP HR L&D OC Wellness Other	Begin by: Complete by:	○ Yes ○ No

**Support Partner = A person who provides guidance, accountability, or expertise (e.g., manager, peer, mentor, expert etc.) **EAP = Employee Assistance Program; L&D = OVGI Learning and Development department; HR = OVGI Human Resources; OC = OVGI Opportunity Center; Wellness = OVGI Health and Wellness Department*